

Department of Veterans Affairs (VADoD)

United States

The Veterans Health Administration, in collaborations with the Department of Defence and other leading professional organizations, has been developing clinical practice guidelines since the early 1990s. Implementation of evidence-based clinical practice guidelines is one strategy VHA has embraced to improve care by reducing variation in practice and systematizing “best practices”. Guidelines address patient cohorts, serve to reduce errors, and provide consistent quality of care and utilization of resources throughout and between the VA and DOD health care systems. Guidelines are also cornerstones for accountability and facilitate learning and the conduct of research.

<https://www.va.gov/vadodhealth/>

Link to recommendations: <https://www.healthquality.va.gov/guidelines/mh/mdd/>

Table

Recommended treatments by VADoD according to their empirical support

Strong	-
Moderate	-
Weak/Controversial	Acceptance and commitment therapy (Individual or Group format) ^{1, 5, 5+, 8+} , Behavioural activation (Individual or Group format) ^{1, 5, 5+, 8+} , Cognitive-behavioural therapy (Individual or Group format) ^{1, 3, 5, 5+, 8+} , Cognitive-behavioural therapy based bibliotherapy ⁺ , Computer/Internet cognitive-behavioural therapy ^{6+, 7+} , Couples therapy, Interpersonal psychotherapy (Individual or Group format) ^{1, 3, 5, 5+, 8+} , Mindfulness-based cognitive therapy (Individual or Group format) ^{1, 3, 5, 5+, 8+} , Non-directive supportive therapy, Problem-solving therapy (Individual or Group format) ^{1, 5, 5+, 8+} , Short-term psychodynamic therapy (Individual or Group format) ^{1, 5, 5+, 8+}
Insufficient	Combining components from psychotherapy approaches
No evidence	-
assessment	
First line	Acceptance and commitment therapy (Individual or Group format) ^{1, 5, 5+, 8+} , Behavioural activation (Individual or Group format) ^{1, 5, 5+, 8+} , Cognitive-behavioural therapy (Individual or Group format) ^{1, 3, 5, 5+, 8+} , Interpersonal psychotherapy (Individual or Group format) ^{1, 3, 5, 5+, 8+} , Mindfulness-based cognitive therapy (Individual or Group format) ^{1, 3, 5, 5+, 8+} , Problem-solving therapy (Individual or Group format) ^{1, 5, 5+, 8+} , Short-term psychodynamic therapy (Individual or Group format) ^{1, 5, 5+, 8+}